The committee of the House of Commons reported 12 March, 1787, that "this prison appears a scene of disorder, irregularity, and intoxication." [1]

"LIMERICK. House of Industry: Very dirty; no order nor regulations. In the kitchen were fowls, and in other rooms, dogs; nuisances, very common in prisons and hospitals, in this country. At the end of the garden are several cells, where lunatics of both sexes were left to the care of one old man. Over these cells, improperly, is the infirmary, which was very dirty. 21 June, 1787, there were thirty-nine men and forty-two women.

"CASTLEBAR. County gaol: The old gaol has no court, no water. Many poor wretches have been almost suffocated in this small prison. Forty-two prisoners have been confined in a room twenty-one feet by seventeen. A new gaol is built on too small a scale, and the cells are close and dark. Gaoler's salary £30.

1788, 31 March. Debtors 4. Felons, etc., 6.

"CAVAN. County gaol: lately built. No court, though a convenient area is contiguous. Water from a well on the outside, into which I saw the rain-water run from the street. The rooms very dirty and offensive; never whitewashed. Prisoners double bolted. The bar-bolts are cruel; for they give more pain to the prisoners when lying or walking than iron chains. Windows closed for fear of tools being conveyed. Here I cannot but remonstrate against the negligence of inspectors and gaolers, and their idle excuses for the omission of washing prisons, on which the health of the prisoners so much depends. The gaoler lives at a distance; salary £20. But by a shameful neglect, neither his salary, nor the fees for acquitted prisoners have been paid him, for four or five years."

1787, 11 July, Debtor 1. Felons, etc., 36.

[From *An Account of Lazarettos*, pp. 78–100.]

[1] It may be thought severe and cruel, especially to debtors, who are not delinquents, that no liquors should be admitted into prisons. But, though the greatest tenderness should be shown to such unfortunate persons, yet the restraint appears necessary; for many sober persons coming into prison, from uneasiness of mind, and the influence of bad examples, have acquired those habits which ended in their ruin: and, the quiet and orderly frequently complain of being disturbed by the noisy and quarrelsome. It appears therefore absolutely necessary, that a new body of rules and orders be fixed by Parliament, for the government of debtors, as well as felons, in all prisons. And that not even felons, much less debtors, should be left to the capricious mandates of an insulting gaoler or his turnkeys.

SECTION VII

A PARTICULAR ACCOUNT OF ENGLISH PRISONS

As the tables of which the present section will chiefly consist, contain several terms which cannot be familiar to the generality of my readers, I shall begin with an explanation of them.

In the first page of every county, city, etc., the second article of the gaoler or keeper's emolument is Fees; by which are meant such only as are taken by him and his servants on the admission or discharge of a prisoner. The sums set down against this article are from the best information I could procure in my repeated journeys; but they differ sometimes from those specified in the tables of fees, where such are found.

The next article under gaoler is Transports. The sum set down to this, is what (from the best intelligence I could gain) I found was allowed them for conveying convicts sentenced to transportation to the respective seaports; and for paying the merchant or contractor what he was supposed to demand for their passage: although by the statutes fourth George I and and eighth of his present Majesty, it is enacted that "The person or persons so contracting . . . shall have a property and interest in the service of the said offenders for such terms of years."

With respect to the following article, Licence, I shall observe that in some places, as at Warwick, Oxford, Worcester, Exeter, Chester City, Yarmouth, Colchester, Carlisle, Montgomery, Monmouth, Usk, etc., the gaoler has no licence, and yet is permitted, by connivance, to sell beer, and some gaolers even wine to the prisoners, and their visitors. In these cases I have made no distinction.

Under Prisoners in the same page, the number which I found in the respective county gaol on my different visits is distinguished into debtors and felons, etc. The etc. is meant to include two kinds of prisoners chiefly; viz. fines and petty offenders. By fines are understood such as are detained till they pay a sum of money, a fine—such as are obliged to find security for good behaviour—and such as are committed for a